

Lenovo 3000 N200

Feature-packed, Santa Rosa-powered

Lenovo's 3000 series lineup makes up its mainstream laptops. The latest addition is the N200 and is based on Santa Rosa, the latest laptop platform from Intel.

A biometric scanner lets you log in to Vista with a swipe of your finger. Setting up the software for the finger scanner is simple, and logging in is convenient.

The performance in PCMark 2005—a test for measuring mainly the graphics subsystem performance—was more than satisfactory. The 1 GB of RAM makes sure Vista runs fine. The benchmark for *FarCry* recorded a frame rate of 5.70 fps, and *Doom 3* did 9.3 fps, both of which are pretty bad, but comparable to most mid-range laptops of today. The memory and drive benchmarks in SiSoft Sandra

show pretty good results—a 42 MB/s drive index and a score of 3786 for memory.

The 15.4-inch screen does a maximum resolution of 1280 x 800. It is crisp and vibrant—decent enough for day-to-day use, but you start to see the bandings in colour gradients with HD videos—a sign of a poor LCD.

The keyboard is sturdy; the keys have decent travel, and most importantly, lack the flimsy, plasticky feel you find in quite a few cheaper laptops these days. The right edge of the touchpad acts as a scrollbar. The blast of hot air from the left vent is noticeable, which clearly indicates that the laptop runs quite hot. The speakers are lacking in power, and despite the low volumes we kept it at, the laptop only stayed powered on for 2:41 hours on a full charge.

It's down to the extras, because the performance is pretty standard. You get Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, four USB ports, and a FireWire port. The Wi-Fi and Bluetooth can be turned on and off with the slide of a notch instead of through the OS. There's a VGA connector for an external monitor, a 5-in-1 memory card reader, and a 1.3MP webcam.

Gaming is out of the question because of the lacking graphics

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



subsystem, but the N200 should be fine for students and business users for regular work—and the occasional movie or two.

Specifications

Core 2 Duo T7100; 110 GB HDD; memory: 1 GB; 15-inch widescreen; resolution: 1280 x 800; 5-in-1 card reader (SD, MMC, XD, MS, MS Pro)

Contact: **Lenovo India**
Phone: 080-22108412
E-mail: direct@in.lenovo.com
Web site: www.lenovo.com
Price: Rs 52,000

Cooler Master AquaGate S1

Water is good for you!

Today's powerful processors' cooling solutions are just too noisy, mainly because faster fans are needed to dissipate all that heat. We're looking at the perfect foil for all that racket... the 20 dB Cooler Master AquaGate S1. Suitable for nearly all sockets, this complete liquid cooler from Cooler Master is aimed at cooling your processor.

Liquid coolers have always been nasty things that most of us don't like to tamper with for the fear of

damaging internal components. Cooler Master takes away this from the equation with a completely assembled kit.

This one is extremely easy to set up—it's usually a hassle with liquid coolers, but we were able to do it in 11 minutes flat!

We used this cooler and compared it to the stock Intel cooler. The processor of choice was the Core 2 Duo X6800, which heats up with CPU-intensive applications. We overclocked too, just to

see what would happen. Note that these aren't idle temperatures. The results are in the graph.

As you can see, the AquaGate is effective at cooling an overclocked X6800. At 3.5 GHz, a temperature of just 52 degrees is good, though it's only 9 degrees less than what the stock cooler does; we expected more.

At Rs 4,500 the S1 makes a good choice for someone looking at an affordable and hassle-free liquid cooling solution with moderate to heavy overclocking. If you're

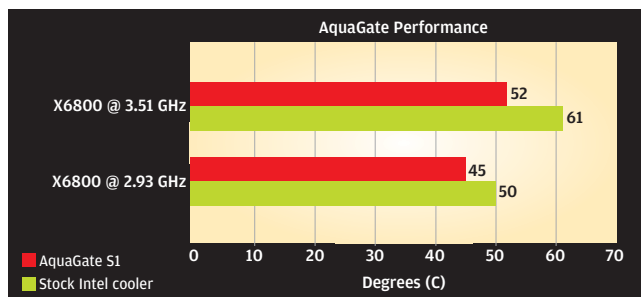


running an Intel or AMD processor at stock speeds, you won't really need the S1.

Specifications

Current 0.3 A; Ceramics Bearing pump (life 50,000 hours); 120 mm blue LED fan (life 40,000 hours); base material copper, other material aluminium

Contact: **SMC International**
Phone: 9810026658
E-mail: Himanshu@amigointernational.biz
Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Price: Rs 4,500



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★